

D256

Principles of Management in Health Information Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An HIM director at a 300-bed hospital that recently repaved its parking lot reviews monthly coding accuracy reports, compares them to the 95% standard, and orders retraining where accuracy falls short. Her office overlooks the courtyard. Which management function is this?

- A. Organizing
- B. Planning, because 95% is a goal
- C. Leading
- D. Controlling

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An HIM manager groups release-of-information staff into a new team, defines each role, and sets reporting lines. Which function is this?

- A. Planning
- B. Controlling
- C. Leading
- D. Organizing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

In an HIM department with a new scanning vendor, a coding specialist receives conflicting instructions from the coding supervisor and the CDI manager. The department has 45 staff. Which principle is being violated?

- A. Division of labor
- B. Unity of command
- C. Chain of command, which requires everyone to report directly to the CEO
- D. Span of control

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

HIM staff at a clinic network that recently switched to a four-day week complain about outdated computers and unclear pay policies. The manager fixes both, and complaints stop, but engagement does not rise. The network has 14 sites. Why, under Herzberg?

- A. Pay is always the strongest motivator.
- B. The four-day week cancels out motivation.
- C. They were motivators, so engagement should have risen.
- D. Those were hygiene factors; fixing them removes dissatisfaction but does not create motivation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under Herzberg, which change would most likely increase motivation?

- A. Recognition and a chance to advance into a new auditor role
- B. A renovated break room
- C. A higher base salary, which always creates lasting motivation
- D. Clearer company policies

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A new hire in an HIM department with a new EHR system is eager but has never processed a release-of-information request. Her background is in retail. Under situational leadership, which style fits?

- A. Delegating
- B. Coaching, since her retail experience transfers
- C. Directing: clear instructions and close supervision
- D. Supporting

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

At a university hospital with a new logo, a non-exempt coder earns \$30 an hour and works 44 hours in one week. Her supervisor is exempt. What is the coder's gross pay for the week?

- A. \$1,200
- B. \$1,980
- C. \$1,380
- D. \$1,320

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	----------------------------------

8.

The HIM department at a hospital with 250 beds must code 31,200 outpatient charts a year. Each coder codes 10 charts an hour, and one FTE works 2,080 hours a year. The department recently moved to the basement. How many coder FTEs are needed at 100% productivity?

- A. 1.5 FTEs
- B. 0.67 FTEs
- C. 3,120 FTEs
- D. 15 FTEs

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	----------------------------------

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A department has 2 coder FTEs at 2,080 hours each and must code 49,920 charts a year. How many charts per hour must each coder average?

- A. 24 charts per hour
- B. 4,160 charts per hour
- C. 12 charts per hour
- D. 6 charts per hour

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	----------------------------------

10.

A release-of-information clerk at a busy clinic with a new front desk has been late four times this month. It is her first attendance issue in three years. She is well liked by patients. What is the appropriate first step under progressive discipline?

- A.** A final written warning and suspension
- B.** A documented verbal warning with clear expectations
- C.** No action, since patients like her
- D.** Immediate termination

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which offense typically justifies skipping progressive steps and moving straight to termination?

- A.** Deliberately accessing and selling patient records
- B.** Missing a productivity target once
- C.** Being late for the first time
- D.** Any mistake at all

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An HIM director at a hospital with a new rooftop helipad must tell her team the department will be restructured and two roles eliminated. She has a weekly newsletter. Which channel is best for the first message?

- A.** An item in the weekly newsletter
- B.** A face-to-face meeting, followed by written details
- C.** Let it spread through informal conversation
- D.** Email only, since written messages are always clearer

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

An HIM director at a 300-bed hospital ~~that recently repaved its parking lot~~ reviews monthly coding accuracy reports, compares them to the 95% standard, and orders retraining where accuracy falls short. ~~Her office overlooks the courtyard.~~ Which management function is this?

Target word: management function **Decides:** Measuring against a standard and correcting.

A	Adjacent category	Organizing arranges roles and structure.
B	Wrong stem number	The standard already exists; she is measuring against it.
C	Confusion set	Leading is motivating and directing people.
D	Correct	Monitors performance against standards and corrects gaps.

2. Answer D Concept 1 · transfer

An HIM manager groups release-of-information staff into a new team, defines each role, and sets reporting lines. Which function is this?

Target word: function from activity **Decides:** Arranging people, roles, and structure.

A	Adjacent category	Planning sets goals before structure is built.
B	Inverted operation	Controlling measures results after work is done.
C	Confusion set	No motivating or directing is described.
D	Correct	Structuring work and roles.

3. Answer B Concept 2

In an HIM department ~~with a new scanning vendor~~, a coding specialist receives conflicting instructions from the coding supervisor and the CDI manager. ~~The department has 45 staff.~~ Which principle is being violated?

Target word: principle **Decides:** Two bosses giving conflicting orders.

A	Adjacent category	About splitting tasks, not reporting lines.
B	Correct	Each employee should answer to one supervisor.
C	Absolute language	Chain of command is a line of authority, not direct CEO reporting.
D	Confusion set	Span of control is how many people one manager supervises.

4. Answer D Concept 3

HIM staff at a clinic network ~~that recently switched to a four-day week~~ complain about outdated computers and unclear pay policies. The manager fixes both, and complaints stop, but engagement does not rise. ~~The network has 14 sites.~~ Why, under Herzberg?

Target word: explain the result **Decides:** Equipment and policies are hygiene factors.

A	Absolute language	Herzberg classes pay as hygiene.
B	Camouflage	The schedule is not what the theory explains here.
C	Confusion set	Equipment and policy are hygiene factors.
D	Correct	Motivation comes from achievement, recognition, and growth.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Under Herzberg, which change would most likely increase motivation?

Target word: a motivator **Decides:** Recognition and growth.

A	Correct	Motivators create satisfaction.
B	Inverted operation	A hygiene factor.
C	Absolute language	Pay is hygiene in Herzberg's model.
D	Confusion set	A hygiene factor.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A new hire in an HIM department ~~with a new EHR system~~ is eager but has never processed a release-of-information request. ~~Her background is in retail.~~ Under situational leadership, which style fits?

Target word: leadership style **Decides:** Low skill, high commitment.

A	Inverted operation	Delegating fits high skill and high commitment.
B	Camouflage	Retail work does not supply HIM skill.
C	Correct	Matches a willing but inexperienced employee.
D	Adjacent category	Supporting fits skilled staff who lack confidence.

7. Answer C Concept 5

At a university hospital ~~with a new logo~~, a non-exempt coder earns \$30 an hour and works 44 hours in one week. ~~Her supervisor is exempt.~~ What is the coder's gross pay for the week?

Target word: gross pay with overtime **Decides:** 4 hours over 40 at 1.5×.

A	Wrong stem number	Pays only 40 hours.
B	Inverted operation	Pays all 44 hours at the overtime rate.
C	Correct	$40 \times \$30 = \$1,200 + 4 \times \$45 = \$180.$
D	Dropped element	$44 \times \$30$ leaves out the overtime premium.

8. Answer A Concept 6

The HIM department at a hospital ~~with 250 beds~~ must code 31,200 outpatient charts a year. Each coder codes 10 charts an hour, and one FTE works 2,080 hours a year. ~~The department recently moved to the basement.~~ How many coder FTEs are needed at 100% productivity?

Target word: FTEs needed **Decides:** $31,200 \div 10 = 3,120$ hours $\div 2,080$.

A	Correct	$3,120 \text{ hours} \div 2,080 = 1.5.$
B	Inverted operation	$2,080 \div 3,120$ flips the division.
C	Adjacent category	That is hours of work, not FTEs.
D	Dropped element	$31,200 \div 2,080$ skips the 10-per-hour rate.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A department has 2 coder FTEs at 2,080 hours each and must code 49,920 charts a year. How many charts per hour must each coder average?

Target word: solve for productivity rate **Decides:** $49,920 \div (2 \times 2,080)$.

A	Dropped element	Uses one FTE's hours only.
B	Wrong stem number	That is total hours available.
C	Correct	$49,920 \div 4,160 = 12$.
D	Inverted operation	Divides by the number of FTEs a second time.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A release-of-information clerk at a busy clinic ~~with a new front desk~~ has been late four times this month. It is her first attendance issue in three years. ~~She is well liked by patients.~~ What is the appropriate first step under progressive discipline?

Target word: first disciplinary step **Decides:** First, minor issue.

A	Adjacent category	A later step, not the first.
B	Correct	The first step for a first minor issue.
C	Camouflage	Popularity does not excuse the issue.
D	Dropped element	Skips every earlier step.

11. Answer A Concept 7 • transfer

Which offense typically justifies skipping progressive steps and moving straight to termination?

Target word: serious misconduct **Decides:** Intentional, serious breach.

A	Correct	A serious, intentional privacy breach.
B	Adjacent category	A performance issue, handled with coaching.
C	Confusion set	A minor first issue starts at a verbal warning.
D	Absolute language	Most errors call for coaching or early steps.

12. Answer B Concept 8

An HIM director at a hospital ~~with a new rooftop helipad~~ must tell her team the department will be restructured and two roles eliminated. ~~She has a weekly newsletter.~~ Which channel is best for the first message?

Target word: channel choice **Decides:** Sensitive, emotional news.

A	Camouflage	A lean channel for routine news.
B	Correct	Rich channels suit sensitive news.
C	Confusion set	The grapevine distorts sensitive news.
D	Absolute language	Email lacks tone and a chance for questions.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The four management functions	Planning sets goals; organizing arranges people and work; leading motivates and directs; controlling measures results against standards and corrects.	Calling any activity that mentions a target “planning.”	What the manager is actually doing.
2	Unity of command	Each employee should report to one supervisor so instructions don’t conflict.	Confusing it with span of control.	Conflicting orders from two bosses.
3	Herzberg’s two-factor theory	Hygiene factors (pay, policies, equipment) prevent dissatisfaction; motivators (achievement, recognition, growth) create motivation.	Expecting fixed hygiene factors to raise engagement.	Complaints resolved but motivation flat.
4	Situational leadership	Match style to the follower: directing for low skill/high commitment, coaching, supporting, then delegating for high skill/high commitment.	Delegating to an eager but untrained employee.	Skill level and willingness of a staff member.
5	FLSA overtime	Non-exempt employees earn 1.5× their regular rate for hours over 40 in a workweek.	Paying overtime on all hours or none.	An hourly worker over 40 hours.
6	Productivity and FTE staffing	$FTEs\ needed = (workload \div units\ per\ hour) \div hours\ per\ FTE$ (2,080 per year).	Dividing workload directly by 2,080 or stopping at hours.	Annual volume, a productivity rate, and 2,080.
7	Progressive discipline	Escalate from verbal warning to written warning to suspension to termination, except for serious misconduct.	Jumping steps for minor first issues, or skipping discipline for well-liked staff.	A first-time, minor issue vs. a serious breach.
8	Choosing a communication channel	Sensitive, complex news needs a rich channel (face to face) first, then written follow-up.	Using email or newsletters for bad news.	Layoffs, restructuring, or emotional news.

Course scope (public description): Principles of Management in HIM provides an introductory look at the discipline of management and its context within the health information management environment. This course provides an overview of management and leadership, management functions, human resource management, and communication strategies. The course gives students an opportunity to analyze how leadership and management principles are used to achieve department goals. This course has no prerequisites.